

Nielsen Norman Group Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Use this workbook
to conduct your
own heuristic
evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10
Usability Heuristics, look
for specific places where
the interface fails to
adhere to the guideline.

Write your
recommenda
tions for how
to fix those
usability
issues

N/g

<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/> Nielsen
Norman Group

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

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Date:
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Product:
Task:

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

- The system does not clearly show a loading indicator during form submission.
- Users may not immediately know if their action was successful.
- Some pages take time to load without progress feedback.

Recommendations

- Add loading indicators.
- Show confirmation messages.
- Display status updates.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

- Some technical terms may be difficult for first-time users to understand.
- Certain labels are too system-oriented instead of user-friendly.
- Navigation labels are not always familiar to ordinary users.

Recommendations

- Use simple language.
- Use familiar terms.
- Organize information clearly.

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

- Users cannot easily undo accidental actions.
 - There is no clear cancel button in some processes.
- Users may accidentally leave pages without warning.

Recommendations

- Add undo options.
- Add cancel buttons.
- Show exit confirmations.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

- Some buttons use different labels for the same action.
- Font sizes and spacing are inconsistent in some sections.
- Different page layouts may confuse users.

Recommendations

- Use consistent labels.
- Keep the same design style.
- Follow standard layouts.

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Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

- Users can accidentally delete records without confirmation.
- Forms allow incomplete or invalid input.
- There are limited warnings before risky actions.

Recommendations

- Add delete confirmations.
- Validate inputs.
- Show warning messages.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

- Users need to remember previous filter settings.
- Important options are hidden in menus.
- Navigation items are not always visible.

Recommendations

- Keep important tools visible.
- Show recent actions.
- Add clear icons and labels.

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7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts – hidden from novice users – may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

- The system lacks shortcuts for experienced users.
- Users cannot customize dashboard views.
- Repetitive actions take too many steps.

Recommendations

- Add shortcuts.
- Allow customization.
- Reduce extra steps.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

- Some dashboard sections contain unnecessary information.
- Too many elements reduce readability.
 - Certain tables appear crowded.

Recommendations

- Remove unnecessary content.
- Improve spacing.
- Simplify the layout.

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Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

- Error messages are not specific enough.
- Users are not informed which field contains an error.
- Some error messages lack recovery instructions.

Recommendations

- Use simple error messages.
- Highlight errors clearly.
- Suggest solutions.

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

- The system has limited user help documentation.
 - First-time users may not understand some features.
- There are no tooltips or guides available.

Recommendations

- Add a help section.
- Include tooltips.
- Provide simple guides.